INC-2026-08-07: Nightly batch job that settles captured payments with acquir degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV3 · service settlement-worker · author m.oyelaran

Started 2026-08-07T02:00:00Z · detected 2026-08-07T02:03:00Z · resolved 2026-08-07T02:34:00Z

Customer impact

Settlement completed 6 hours late for 12,300 payments. Payouts were unaffected as the acquirer window had not closed.

Root cause

The settlement queue accumulated a backlog after an acquirer returned HTTP 429 for sustained periods, and the worker had no adaptive rate limiting.

Affected services

settlement-worker. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on settlement-worker.

Timeline (UTC)

02:00 — First symptoms observed on settlement-worker.

02:03 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for settlement-worker.

02:17 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

02:34 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Review the third-party contract for change notification.

• Add saturation alerting to settlement-worker at 80% of limits.

• Require a load test for configuration changes of this class.